

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 10

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1. Acumen

Meaning: The ability to make quick and intelligent decisions.

Tip to remember: Think of a sharp “IQ mind.” Acumen means sharp judgment.

Sentence: Her business acumen helped the company grow rapidly.

2. Antithesis

Meaning: The exact opposite of something.

Tip to remember: “Anti” means opposite. Antithesis means the opposite idea or person.

Sentence: Laziness is the antithesis of success.

3. Ascribe

Meaning: To attribute something to a cause, source, or person.

Tip to remember: Think of writing someone’s name beside a cause. You ascribe the result to that cause.

Sentence: The scientist ascribed the failure to poor experimental design.

4. Befuddled

Meaning: Confused or unable to think clearly.

Tip to remember: Befuddled sounds like “brain in a puddle.” A befuddled mind is messy and confused.

Sentence: The difficult question left the students befuddled.

5. Eschew

Meaning: To deliberately avoid or stay away from something.

Tip to remember: Eschew sounds like “chew.” If you eschew junk food, you refuse to chew it.

Sentence: He decided to eschew distractions while preparing for the GRE.

6. Esoteric

Meaning: Understood by only a small number of people with special knowledge.

Tip to remember: Think of secret expert knowledge hidden inside a small circle. That is esoteric.

Sentence: The paper discussed esoteric concepts in power system optimization.

7. **Evasive**
Meaning: Avoiding a direct answer or clear response.
Tip to remember: Evasive comes from evade, meaning avoid. An evasive answer avoids the truth.
Sentence: The politician gave an evasive reply to the journalist's question.
8. **Exculpate**
Meaning: To prove that someone is not guilty.
Tip to remember: "Ex" means out, and "culp" means blame. Exculpate means to take someone out of blame.
Sentence: The new evidence exculpated the accused student.
9. **Expedite**
Meaning: To make a process happen faster.
Tip to remember: Expedite sounds like "express speed." It means to speed something up.
Sentence: The officer helped expedite the visa application.
10. **Fastidious**
Meaning: Very attentive to detail; hard to please.
Tip to remember: Think of a person who checks every tiny detail before accepting anything. That person is fastidious.
Sentence: The fastidious editor found even the smallest grammar mistakes.
11. **Feign**
Meaning: To pretend or fake.
Tip to remember: Feign sounds like "fake." To feign illness means to fake illness.
Sentence: He tried to feign confidence during the interview.
12. **Furtive**
Meaning: Secretive, sneaky, or trying not to be noticed.
Tip to remember: Think of a thief making furtive movements in the dark.
Sentence: She gave a furtive glance at her phone during class.
13. **Hamper**
Meaning: To hinder, obstruct, or make progress difficult.
Tip to remember: Think of a basket blocking your path. It hampers your movement.
Sentence: Lack of funding hampered the research project.
14. **Indispensable**
Meaning: Absolutely necessary; essential.
Tip to remember: If something cannot be dispensed with or removed, it is indispensable.
Sentence: Clear communication is indispensable for teamwork.
15. **Lament**
Meaning: To express sadness or regret.

Tip to remember: Think of someone crying and saying, “Why did this happen?” That is lamenting.

Sentence: The villagers lamented the loss of the old forest.

16. **Myopic**

Meaning: Short-sighted; lacking long-term vision.

Tip to remember: In eyesight, myopia means you cannot see far. In GRE, myopic means you cannot think far ahead.

Sentence: The company’s myopic focus on profit damaged its reputation.

17. **Nonchalant**

Meaning: Calm and relaxed, often in a way that shows lack of concern.

Tip to remember: Think of someone saying, “No challenge,” and staying relaxed. That is nonchalant.

Sentence: He remained nonchalant even before the difficult exam.

18. **Partial**

Meaning: Biased toward one side; also, incomplete.

Tip to remember: Partial can mean “part only” or “favoring one part.” On the GRE, it often means biased.

Sentence: The judge must not be partial to either side.

19. **Pensive**

Meaning: Deeply thoughtful, often with sadness.

Tip to remember: Pensive sounds like “pensieve,” a container of thoughts in Harry Potter. A pensive person is full of thoughts.

Sentence: She became pensive after hearing the sad news.

20. **Portend**

Meaning: To indicate or warn that something is likely to happen.

Tip to remember: Think of dark clouds that portend rain. They signal what is coming.

Sentence: The sudden drop in sales may portend financial trouble.

21. **Provincial**

Meaning: Narrow-minded or limited in outlook; related to a province.

Tip to remember: Think of someone who has never looked beyond their small province and rejects outside ideas.

Sentence: His provincial attitude made him unwilling to accept new cultures.

22. **Rudimentary**

Meaning: Basic, simple, or undeveloped.

Tip to remember: Rudimentary sounds like “root.” It means the root-level basics of something.

Sentence: He has only a rudimentary knowledge of programming.

23. **Salutary**

Meaning: Beneficial or good for health, behavior, or improvement.

Tip to remember: Salutory sounds like “salute.” You salute something because it has a good effect.

Sentence: The teacher’s advice had a salutory effect on his study habits.

24. **Sever**

Meaning: To cut off or separate completely.

Tip to remember: Sever sounds like “separate.” To sever means to separate by cutting.

Sentence: The company decided to sever ties with the corrupt supplier.

25. **Slight**

Meaning: Small in degree; also, to insult or treat as unimportant.

Tip to remember: A slight can be a small insult that still hurts.

Sentence: He felt slighted when his contribution was ignored.

26. **Somnolent**

Meaning: Sleepy or causing sleepiness.

Tip to remember: Somnolent sounds like “sleep moment.” It means feeling sleepy.

Sentence: The warm classroom made the students somnolent.

27. **Stoic**

Meaning: Calm and unemotional, especially during pain or difficulty.

Tip to remember: Think of a stone face. A stoic person shows little emotion.

Sentence: She remained stoic despite the criticism.

28. **Supersede**

Meaning: To replace something older or less useful.

Tip to remember: Think of a superior version taking the seat of the old one. It supersedes it.

Sentence: Modern software has superseded many older tools.

29. **Tout**

Meaning: To praise, promote, or advertise strongly.

Tip to remember: Think of someone shouting about a product in the market. That person is touting it.

Sentence: The company touted its new battery as safer and cheaper.

30. **Wane**

Meaning: To decrease gradually in strength, size, or importance.

Tip to remember: Think of the moon waning, becoming smaller night by night.

Sentence: His interest in the project began to wane after several failures.